



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2022 Version A for STA 301 - INTRODUCTION TO DATA SCIENCE (05240) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Instructor Course Evaluations Fall 2022**

Courses Audience: **63**

Responses Received: **25**

Response Ratio: **39.7%**

Report Comments

Results were produced during the Fall 2022 implementation of new course evaluation questions and systems. Courses with final exams conducted on December 8th, 2022, may have overlapped with the evaluation window.

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

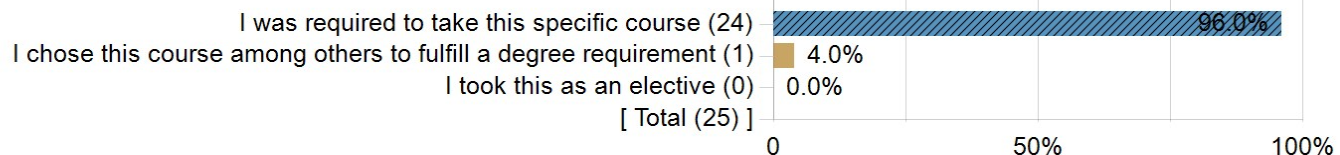
The number of students (e.g. Respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no one method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

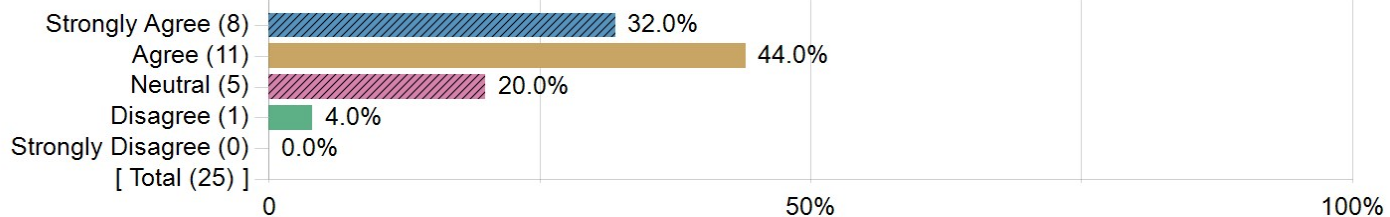
Creation Date: **Thursday, May 4, 2023**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



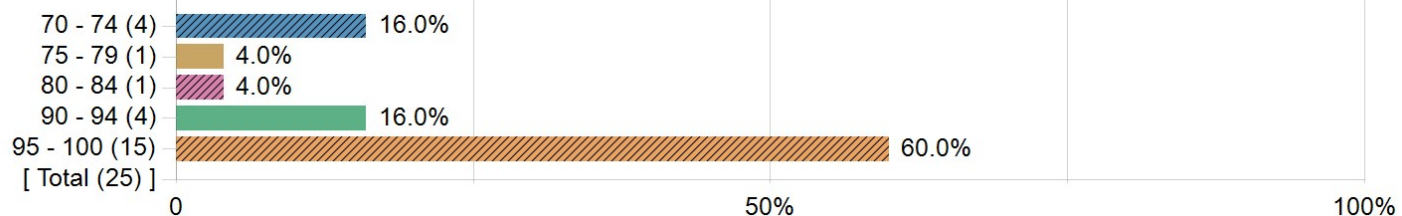
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.04

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



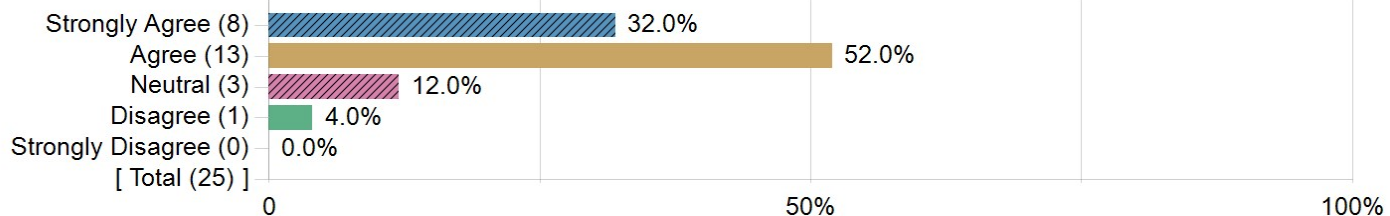
Statistics

Value

Mean

91.48

The course assignments improved my ability to apply logical, numerical, or statistical skills to real-world problems.



Statistics

Value

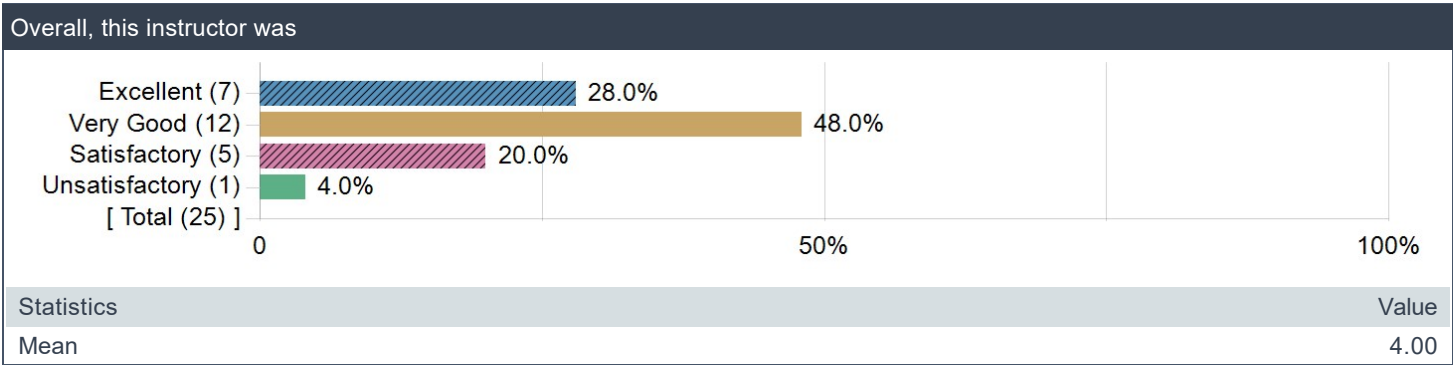
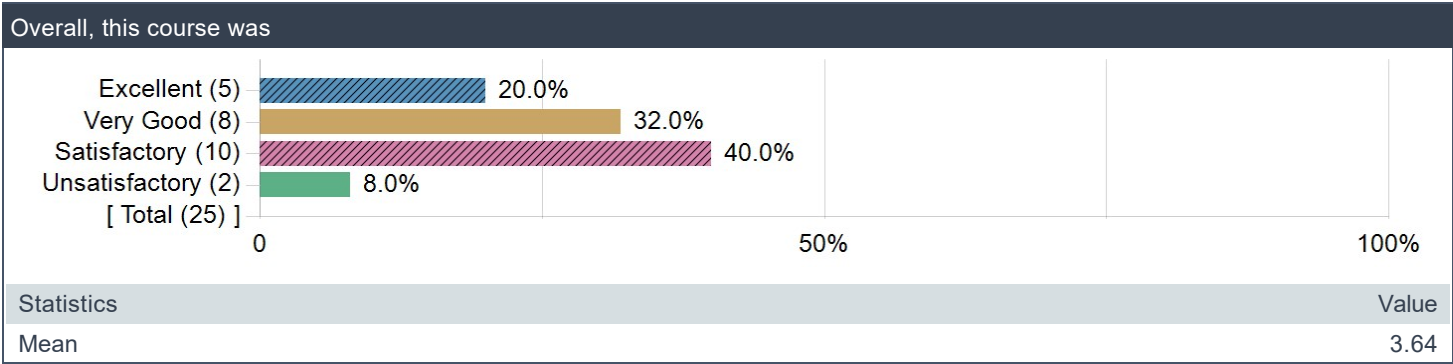
Mean

4.12

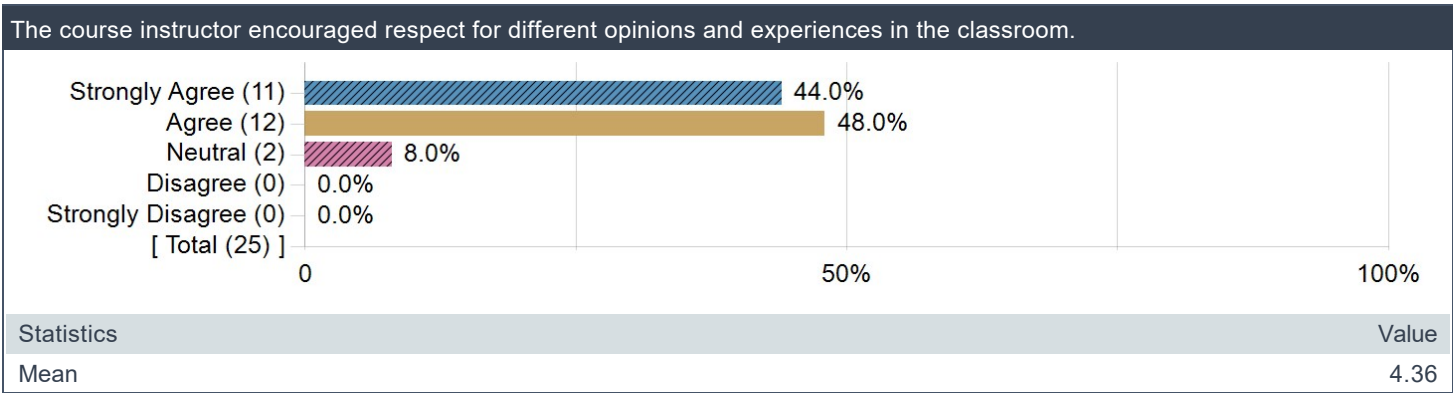
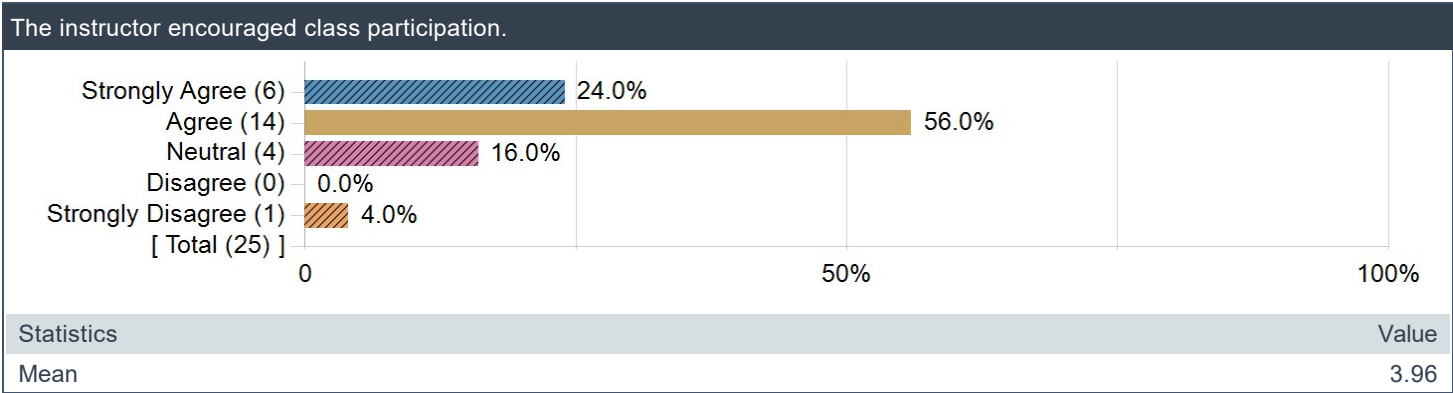
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	24.0%	64.0%	12.0%	0.0%	0.0%	25	4.12
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	48.0%	40.0%	8.0%	4.0%	0.0%	25	4.32
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	20.0%	48.0%	20.0%	12.0%	0.0%	25	3.76
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	20.0%	40.0%	32.0%	4.0%	4.0%	25	3.68
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	36.0%	44.0%	16.0%	4.0%	0.0%	25	4.12

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
The textbook taught more than anything else by far
Doing R actively during class
The Knowledge Checks and lectures both were extremely beneficial in learning the content.
book
Great professor
The professor was very encouraging and approachable, he would stay after class and answer any questions I/other students had. Also, the knowledge checks were very helpful in allowing me to gage my understanding of topic matters as well.
Lesson Readings
online reading of textbook
coming to class and completing my knowledge checks (but actually understanding them and not doing them multiple times just to get them correct)
He was a very good lecturer, I just think the course is designed poorly
Aspects of the course that were most effective in helping my learning were the textbook, homework assignments, and knowledge checks.
Textbook
Engaged class
Honestly, just the textbook. I learned very little to no R in class or from my teacher.
The knowledge checks
textbook
The online textbook
The online r sessions helped a lot.
Having knowledge checks after every class was helpful in making sure that I understood that class' lesson material.
The most effective aspect is helping one learn is the professor's knowledge on terms.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
Very fast-paced
I believe some parts of the Homeworks were challenging, and I found it challenging because I felt as though they were extremely complicated compared to examples we saw in class or in the textbook.
lecture
Terrible participation credit made arbitrarily and we had no idea how they would be done
The coding aspect on R was challenging because the course wasn't solely grasping statistical concepts but also applying them to R which was hard to juggle at times. However, I would urge future students to attend the weekly R sessions held by the TAs as they are super helpful and allows you to meet fellow students and form study groups.
time restraint on midterm
understanding the r coding as it was not focused on much in class
I think the tests (obviously) and the HW's were hard. it was difficult because other people were grading your assignment and they all have different opinions on whether you did something correct or not and if they interpreted your answer the way you did.
The work is very challenging, specifically the homeworks
Th aspect of the course that I found the most challenging was the homework assignments because they were time-consuming and some of the questions were worded a bit confusingly. One thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively is going over the harder homework questions during class before the assignment is due.
I couldn't understand the professor
First year teaching class so he struggled a bit
By far, anything to do with R script and any open ended questions, specifically on the homeworks. I would have liked it if R was taught more in class or if video walkthroughs were posted. Instead, we were left with the just the textbook.
The homework were very long and rigorous
Rstudio
The most challenging was understanding the material most of it is learning on your own.
Using/coding in R was the most challenging part. In the future, doing more of R in class would benefit students.
The challenging aspect of this course is that the program used for homeworks, assignments, and tests is not taught in class nor utilized.